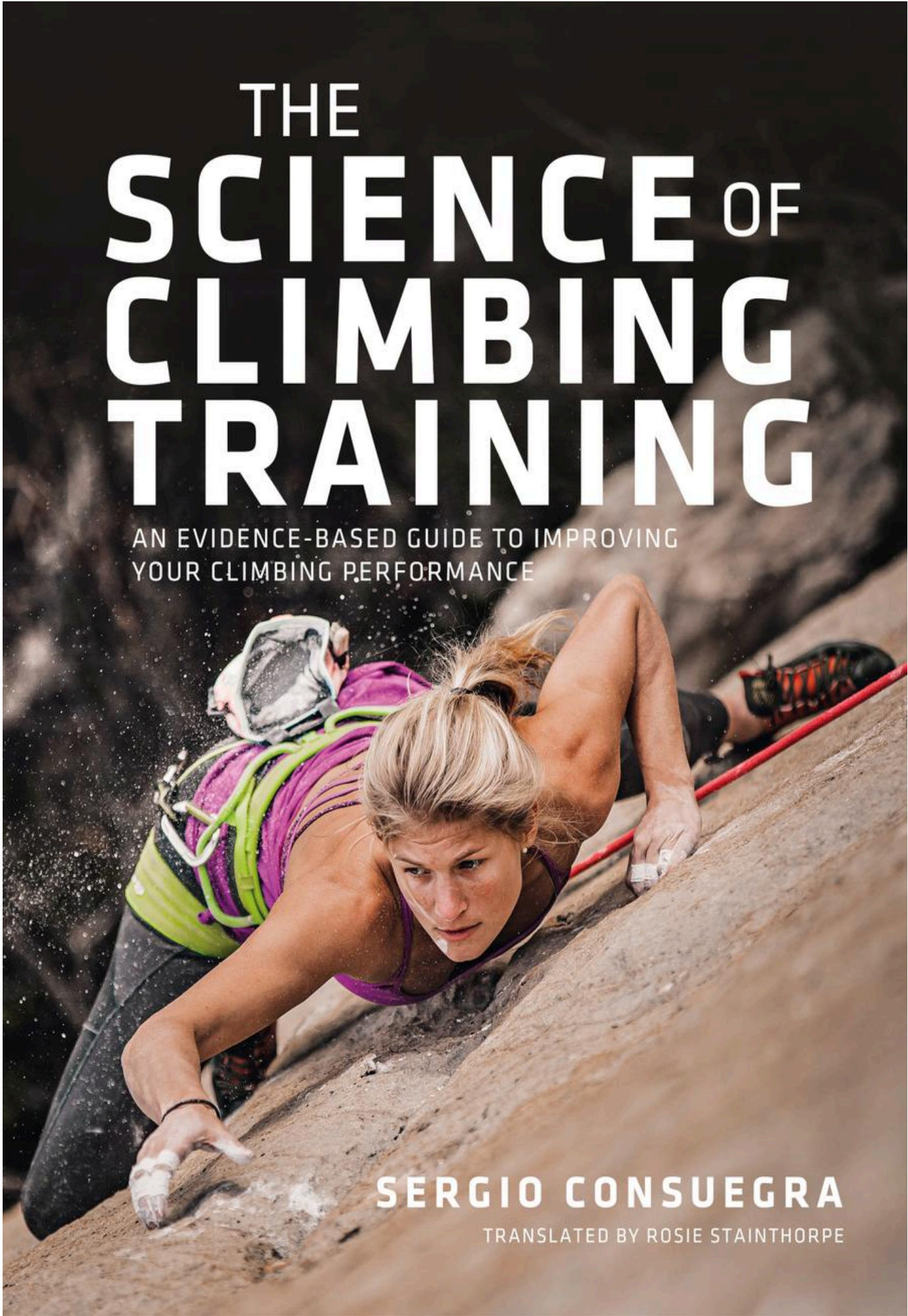




THE SCIENCE OF CLIMBING TRAINING

AN EVIDENCE-BASED GUIDE TO IMPROVING
YOUR CLIMBING PERFORMANCE

SERGIO CONSUEGRA

TRANSLATED BY ROSIE STAINTHORPE

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR



Sergio Consuegra Gómez discovered climbing and mountain sports when he started university, and he graduated with a degree in sports science from UPM university in Madrid (Universidad Politécnica de Madrid). He went on to teach the mountain sports and activities module at UPM for several years. With a keen interest in strength training and the design of training programmes, Sergio is constantly rethinking traditional ideas and championing scientific evidence as the basis of any training plan. It is this approach to training that led him to write this book: focusing on the science behind climbing performance and training, as opposed to methods based solely on personal experience, to provide an evidence-based approach to training for climbing. He's currently the director of coaching at Indoorwall climbing centres and is also an active climbing coach. He lives in Jaca, Spain, where he can get out in the Pyrenees on a daily basis. Find out more at sergioconsuegra.com

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INTRODUCTION

There is an overwhelming amount of information available to us about training for climbing. The rapid growth of sports culture, bigger and better climbing walls, easy access to climbing-related content, the internet ... All have played a huge part in advancing the incredible sport of climbing. However, due to the sheer quantity of information, it's not always easy to sift through and select the most accurate sources. Most people – and not only in the world of climbing – base their training on word of mouth, what friends or influencers are doing, the 'no pain, no gain' mantra, what they've always done, or so-called 'bro science'.

The aim of this book is to provide quality information for a broad range of readers: from climbers taking the next step in their training (whether they're climbing F6a or F8a) to coaches looking to optimise their athletes' training.

It boasts no revolutionary or magic training methods (although you might be shocked by the science behind some popular methods). Instead, it analyses the sporting needs of climbers from the perspective of exercise and sports science to provide an evidence-based approach to climbing training.

The first part explains what training is and how different training methods are governed by the physiological and biomechanical processes that occur in the body.

The second part looks at how to improve specific needs (such as finger strength and forearm muscle endurance) and general needs (basic physical conditioning, pulling strength, pushing strength, strength training for injury prevention, and so on) for the different demands and types of climbing.

The third and final part, after gathering together all the pieces of the puzzle, suggests the best ways in which you can fit them together. It looks at adjusting training volume and intensity and tapering to encourage supercompensation, all to achieve improved performance, a higher grade, ticking your long-standing project or climbing your dream route.

To sum up the contents of this book in just a few words, I'd go with my personal training philosophy: 'don't train more: train better'. And I'd like to think this book will, in the words of Alvin Toffler, help you to 'learn, unlearn and relearn'.